



"Mid-upper" turret had two machine-guns

Spacious fuselage

Engines mounted centrally in "thick" wings that incorporated fuel tanks

◀ SHORT STIRLING MK I

Date	1940	Origin	UK
Wingspan	30.2m (99ft)		
Length	26.6m (87¼ft)		
Top speed	410kph (255mph)		
Engine	Four 768.1kW (1,030hp) Bristol Hercules II two-bank 14-cylinder radials		

The Short Stirling was the first of the British Royal Air Force's "heavies" to reach operational service. It was used in bombing raids over Germany, but was soon superseded by the Handley-Page Halifax and the Avro Lancaster.



Enlarged cockpit canopy gave better visibility for pilot and rear gunner

Bomb-aimer's position

Bomb-aimer's position in "beetle-eye" glazed nose, with single machine-gun

Navigator's and wireless operator's positions below cockpit



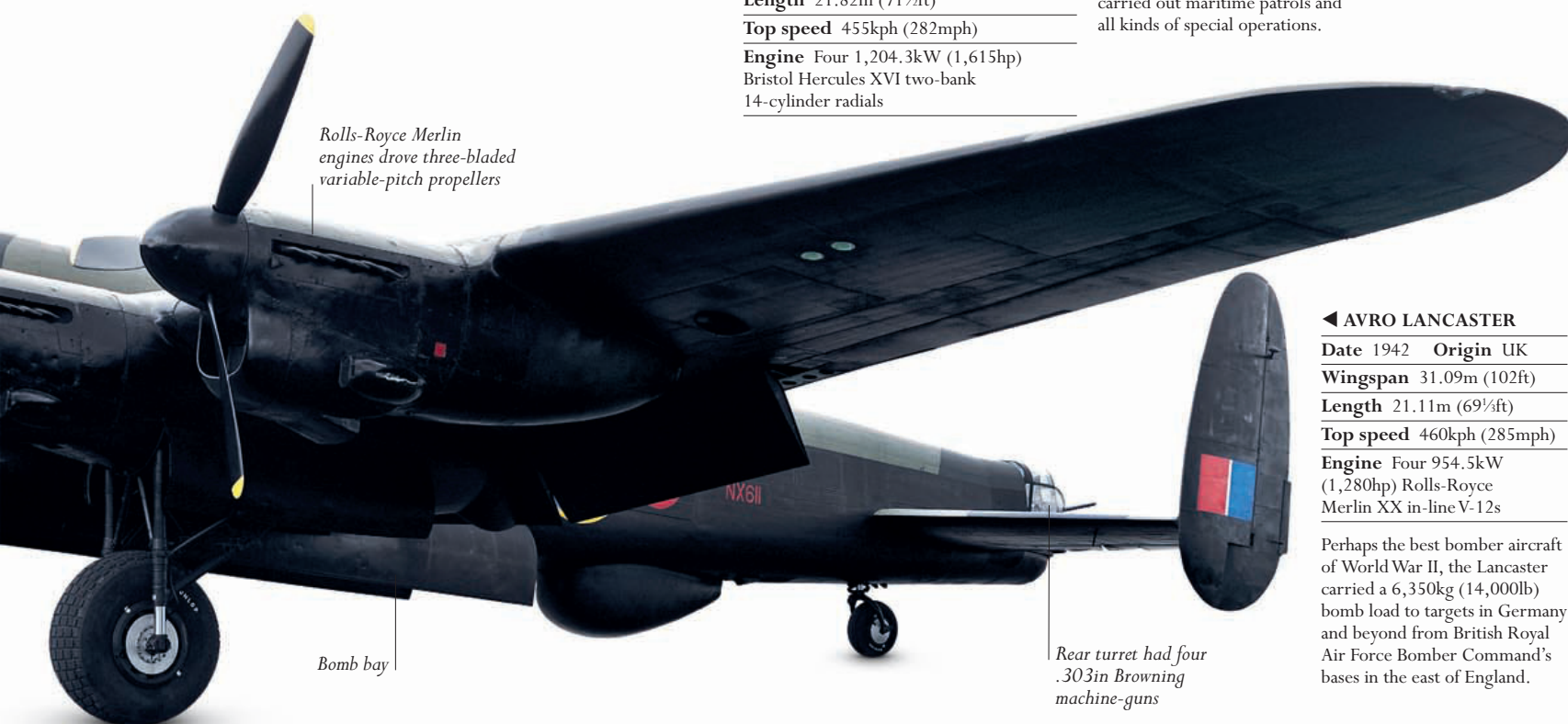
Bristol Hercules radial engines

▲ HANDLEY-PAGE HALIFAX MK III

Date	1942	Origin	UK
Wingspan	31.75m (104¼ft)		
Length	21.82m (71½ft)		
Top speed	455kph (282mph)		
Engine	Four 1,204.3kW (1,615hp) Bristol Hercules XVI two-bank 14-cylinder radials		

The Halifax never achieved the legendary status of the Lancaster, even though it was more versatile and preceded it into service. It carried out maritime patrols and all kinds of special operations.

Tail had turret containing four machine-guns



Rolls-Royce Merlin engines drove three-bladed variable-pitch propellers

Bomb bay

Rear turret had four .303in Browning machine-guns

◀ AVRO LANCASTER

Date	1942	Origin	UK
Wingspan	31.09m (102ft)		
Length	21.11m (69½ft)		
Top speed	460kph (285mph)		
Engine	Four 954.5kW (1,280hp) Rolls-Royce Merlin XX in-line V-12s		

Perhaps the best bomber aircraft of World War II, the Lancaster carried a 6,350kg (14,000lb) bomb load to targets in Germany and beyond from British Royal Air Force Bomber Command's bases in the east of England.



Two .5in machine-guns in dorsal turret

Forward gun turret

◀ CONSOLIDATED B-24 LIBERATOR

Date	1943	Origin	US
Wingspan	33.5m (110ft)		
Length	20.6m (67½ft)		
Top speed	470kph (290mph)		
Engine	Four 894.8kW (1,200hp) Pratt & Whitney R-1830-65 Twin Wasp two-bank 14-cylinder radials		

Lighter, faster, and with a greater carrying capacity than the B-17, the Liberator was to be the most prolific Allied bomber of World War II. However, it was harder to fly than the Flying Fortress, and was never as popular with crews.